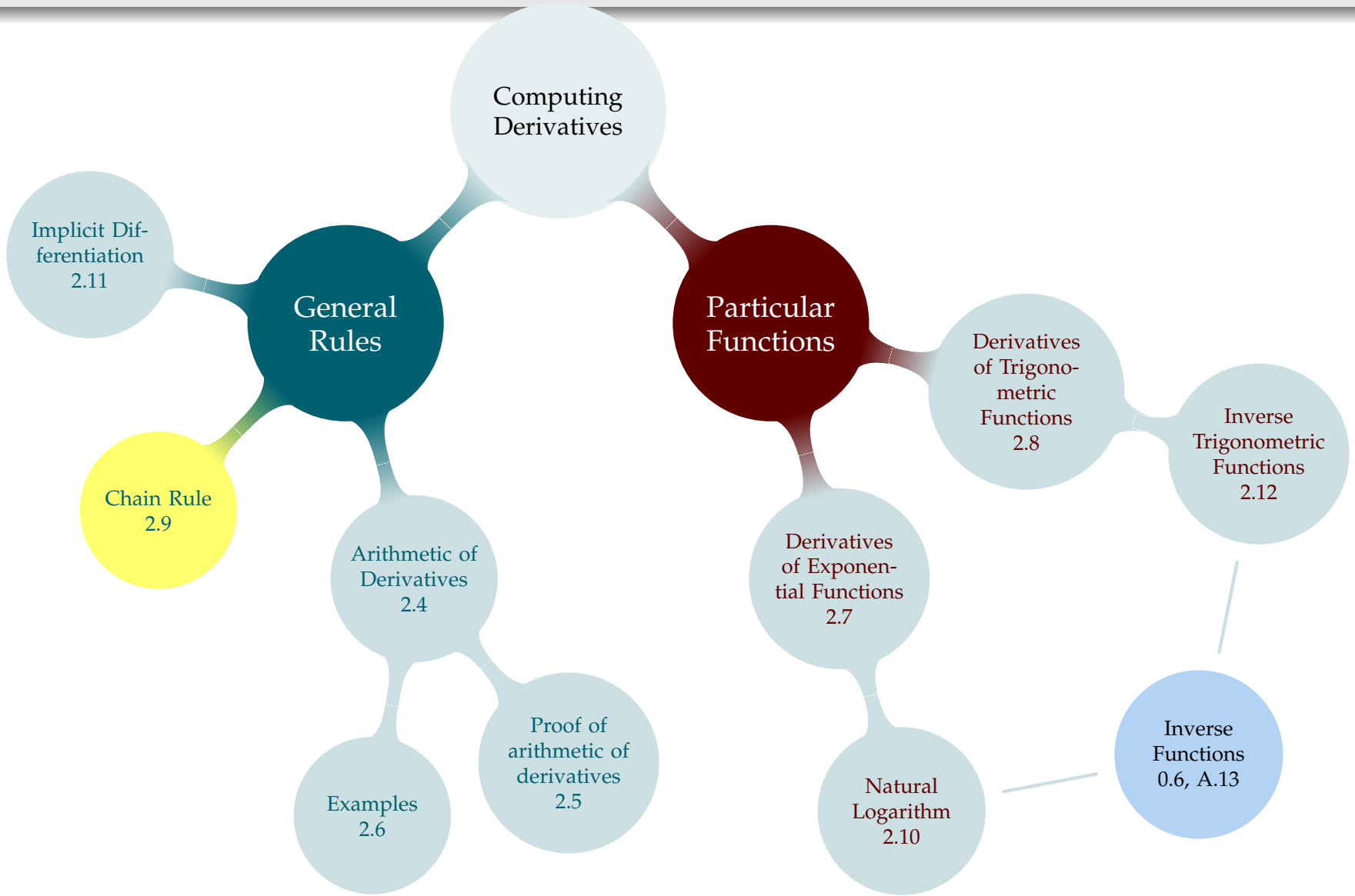
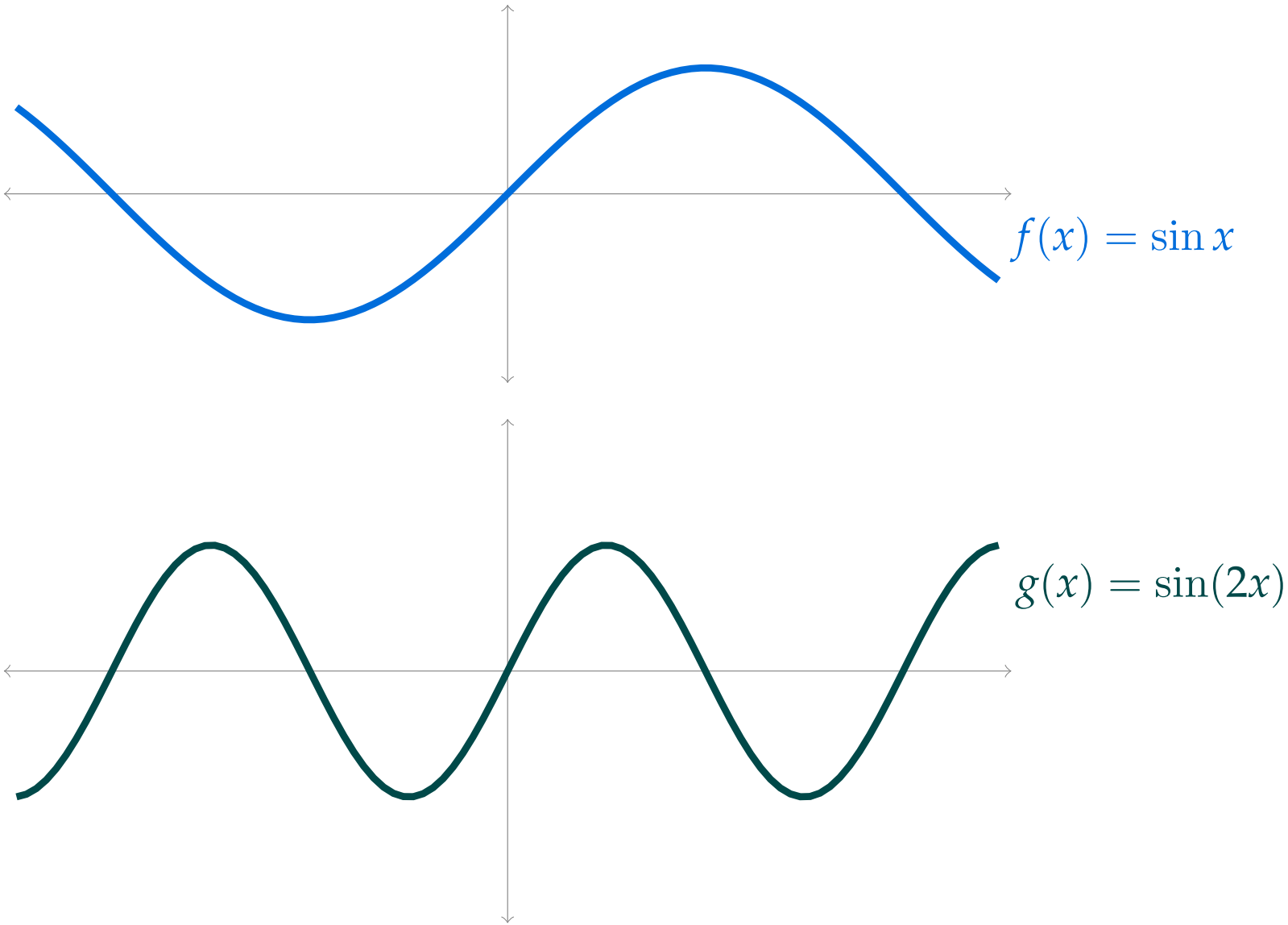
Table of Contents



INTUITION: $\sin x$ VERSUS $\sin(2x)$



Compound Functions

Video: 2:27-3:50

Morton, Jennifer. (2014). *Balancing Act: Otters, Urchins and Kelp*. Available from https://www.kqed.org/quest/67124/balancing-act-otters-urchins-and-kelp

Kelp Population

k kelp population
u urchin population
o otter population
p public policy

$k(u)$ $k(u(o))$ $k(u(o(p)))$

These are examples of compound functions.

Should $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}o}k\big(u(o)\big)$ be positive or negative?
A. positive B. negative C. I'm not sure

Should $k'(u)$ be positive or negative?
A. positive B. negative C. I'm not sure

Differentiating Compound Functions

$$\begin{aligned}
\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}\{f(g(x))\} &= \lim_{h\to 0}\frac{f(g(x+h))-f(g(x))}{h}\\
&= \lim_{h\to 0}\frac{f(g(x+h))-f(g(x))}{h}\left(\frac{g(x+h)-g(x)}{g(x+h)-g(x)}\right)\\
&= \lim_{h\to 0}\frac{f(g(x+h))-f(g(x))}{g(x+h)-g(x)}\cdot\frac{g(x+h)-g(x)}{h}\\
&= \lim_{h\to 0}\frac{f(g(x+h))-f(g(x))}{g(x+h)-g(x)}\cdot\lim_{h\to 0}\frac{g(x+h)-g(x)}{h}\\
&= \lim_{h\to 0}\frac{f\left(\boxed{g(x+h)}\right)-f\left(\boxed{g(x)}\right)}{\boxed{g(x+h)}-\boxed{g(x)}}\cdot g'(x)
\end{aligned}$$

Set $H = g(x+h) - g(x)$. As $h \to 0$, we also have $H \to 0$. So

$$\begin{aligned}
&= \lim_{H\to 0}\frac{f(g(x)+H)-f(g(x))}{H}\cdot g'(x)\\
&= f'(g(x))\cdot g'(x)
\end{aligned}$$

Chain Rule

Chain Rule – Theorem 2.9.3

Suppose f and g are differentiable functions. Then

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}\{f(g(x))\} = f'(g(x))\,g'(x) = \frac{\mathrm{d}f}{\mathrm{d}g}(g(x))\frac{\mathrm{d}g}{\mathrm{d}x}(x)$$

In the case of kelp, $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}o}k(u(o)) = \frac{\mathrm{d}k}{\mathrm{d}u}(u(o))\frac{\mathrm{d}u}{\mathrm{d}o}(o)$

Chain Rule

Suppose f and g are differentiable functions. Then

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}\{f(g(x))\} = f'(g(x))\,g'(x) = \frac{\mathrm{d}f}{\mathrm{d}g}(g(x))\,\frac{\mathrm{d}g}{\mathrm{d}x}(x)$$

Example: suppose $F(x) = \sin(e^x + x^2)$.

$$F(v) = \left(\frac{v}{v^3 + 1} \right)^6$$

NOW YOU 

Let $f(x) = (10^x + \csc x)^{1/2}$. Find $f'(x)$.

NOW YOU 

Suppose $o(t) = e^t$, $u(o) = \frac{1}{o+\sin(o)}$, and $t \geq 10$ (so all these functions are defined). Using the chain rule, find $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t} u\big(o(t)\big)$.
Note: your answer should depend only on t: not o.

Evaluate $\dfrac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}\left\{x^2+\sec\left(x^2+\dfrac{1}{x}\right)\right\}$

Evaluate $\dfrac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}x}\left\{\dfrac{1}{x+\dfrac{1}{x+\frac{1}{x}}}\right\}$

Included Work

 ‘Brain’ by Eucalyp is licensed under CC BY 3.0 (accessed 8 June 2021), 9, 10